

WHAT IS THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN ANOTHER AND OTHER?

A simple rule to help you remember the difference between another and other is:

another + singular noun	<i>I need another cup.</i> (cup is singular so we use another)
other + plural noun	<i>I need other cups.</i> (cup is plural so we use other)
others (a pronoun to replace other + plural noun)	<i>I need others.</i> (refers to other cups)

When to use ANOTHER

Another means:

- one more, an additional, an extra
- a different one; an alternative one

Another is a determiner (and a qualifier) that goes before a singular countable noun or a pronoun.

Another + Singular Countable noun

Another can be followed by a singular countable noun.

- *He has bought another motorbike.*
- *Would you like another cup of coffee?*
- *Don't worry about the rain. We can go another day.*
- *I think you should paint it another color.*
- *We are having another baby.*

Another + One

Another can be placed before "one" when the meaning is clear from the text before it.

- *I have already eaten two sandwiches though now I want another one.* (= an additional sandwich)
- *A: You can borrow more of these books if you like. B: Ok, I'll take another one.* (= another book, one more book)

Another as a pronoun

Sometimes another is used as a pronoun.

- *That piece of cake was tasty. I think I'll have another.* (another = one more piece of cake)
- *I don't like this room. Let's ask for another.* (another = another room)

Note: you can also say: "I think I'll have another one." and "Let's ask for another one."

Another + number + plural noun

Another can be used before a plural noun when there is a number before that noun or before phrases such as a couple of, a few, etc.

- *In another 20 years my laptop is going to be obsolete.*
- *I like this city so much that I'm going to spend another three days here.*
- *We need another three teachers before classes begin.*
- *He was given another couple of months to finish the sculpture.*

Remember another is ONE word not two words (an other is incorrect)

When to use OTHER

Other is a determiner that goes before plural countable nouns, uncountable nouns or a pronoun.

Other + Plural Countable Noun

Other can be followed by a plural countable noun.

- *We have other styles if you are interested.*
- *Have you got any other dresses, or are these the only ones?*
- *Some days are sunny though other days can be very rainy.*
- *I have invited some other people.*
- *I can't help you because I'm busy with other things.*

Other + Ones

Other can be placed before the pronoun "ones" when the meaning is clear from the text before it.

- *We don't need those books, we need other ones.* (= different books)
- *A: You can borrow my books if you like. B: Thanks, but I need other ones.* (= other books)

Note: you can say the other one when it refers to wanting the alternative.

- *I don't want this one, I want the other one.*

Others as a pronoun

Others replaces "other ones" or "other + plural noun". Only others can be used as a pronoun and NOT other.

- *I don't like these postcards. Let's ask for others.* (others = other postcards)
- *Some of the presidents arrived on Monday. Others arrived the following day.*

Others - the others

Often "(the) others" refers to "(the) other people".

- *He has no interest in helping others.* (= in helping other people)
- *What are the others doing tonight?*

What is the difference between other and others?

Other is followed by a noun or a pronoun. Others is a pronoun and is NOT followed by a noun.

- *These shoes are too small. Do you have any other shoes?*
- *These shoes are too small. Do you have any others?* (no noun after others)

PRACTICE:

Complete the sentences below (1 - 18) using either:

ANOTHER / ANOTHER ONE / OTHER / OTHERS / THE OTHER

- (1) We can fit _____ person in my car.
- (2) You shouldn't expect _____ to do your work for you.
- (3) She's finished with that boyfriend and found herself _____.
- (4) The product has many _____ time-saving features.
- (5) This drug can be safely used in combination with _____ medicines.
- (6) Some projects are shorter than _____.
- (7) The man was waiting on _____ side of the street.
- (8) Do you want to exchange this toaster for _____, or do you want your money back?
- (9) Are there any _____ people we should ask?
- (10) We can't afford _____ trip abroad this year.
- (11) The issue affects the fast-food industry, the farming industry and some _____.
- (12) I saw him just _____ day.
- (13) Working for _____ can be very satisfying.
- (14) My passport is valid for _____ two years.
- (15) Some of these methods will work. _____ will not.
- (16) One member of the group might seek participation and greater responsibility, whereas _____ might want to be told what to do.
- (17) Some people dream of success while _____ wake up and work hard at it.
- (18) One person may be interested in sports, _____ in cultural activities.